

a list usually contains more than one element, it's a good idea to make the name of your list plural, such as letters, digits, or names.

In Python, square brackets ([]) indicate a list, and individual elements in the list are separated by commas. Here's a simple example of a list that contains a few kinds of bicycles:

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```
bicycles.py bicycles = ['trek', 'cannondale', 'redline', 'specialized']  
print(bicycles)
```

---

If you ask Python to print a list, Python returns its representation of the list, including the square brackets:

---

```
['trek', 'cannondale', 'redline', 'specialized']
```

---

Because this isn't the output you want your users to see, let's learn how to access the individual items in a list.

### ***Accessing Elements in a List***

Lists are ordered collections, so you can access any element in a list by telling Python the position, or *index*, of the item desired. To access an element in a list, write the name of the list followed by the index of the item enclosed in square brackets.

For example, let's pull out the first bicycle in the list `bicycles`:

---

```
bicycles = ['trek', 'cannondale', 'redline', 'specialized']  
print(bicycles[0])
```

---

When we ask for a single item from a list, Python returns just that element without square brackets:

---

```
trek
```

---

This is the result you want your users to see: clean, neatly formatted output.

You can also use the string methods from Chapter 2 on any element in this list. For example, you can format the element 'trek' to look more presentable by using the `title()` method:

---

```
bicycles = ['trek', 'cannondale', 'redline', 'specialized']  
print(bicycles[0].title())
```

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This example produces the same output as the preceding example, except 'Trek' is capitalized.

### ***Index Positions Start at 0, Not 1***

Python considers the first item in a list to be at position 0, not position 1. This is true of most programming languages, and the reason has to do with